

J Alan Brogan

Engineer, Teacher, Founder, Engineer

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Home: Gortatlea, Tralee, Co Kerry, Ireland. (GMT)

Seeking

Opportunities to pass on great learning.

Story

Dissertation: Designed a system of Kohonen Map & Recurrent Neural Nets and refined it to learn parsed Syntax Trees (of C code)

Started as a teacher, then helped build code, teams, and companies.. Grateful to be a student again now.

Mastered tests, frameworks and crises to Engineer good code reliably delivered to happy users consistently.

Mag Lesbarkeit im Code, Handlungsräume in Tools und die Möglichkeiten modernster Sprachmaschinen.

Experience

[Student, MIT, 2025, Home](#)

“Minds and Machines”

[Engineer, Brightbeam AI, 2025, Home](#)

Refactored prompts to rescue failing project introducing natural language to search engines for Big Enterprise

Mastered requirements translation while mentoring developer through data integration and visualization for Big Pharma.

Strengthened Ops platform, affording developers better options for reviewing, releasing creativity for big gains.

Learned to replace Vim and Python with Claude Code and English. Big changes.

[Principal Engineer, American Tech Services, 2023 to 2024, Home](#)

Re-Engineered a project to generate voiced chatbots, using OpenAI, Google, AI21, Azure, GCP, Twilio APIs

Drove code quality, helping developers to react more easily to changing APIs, and broken APIs through our pipelines.

Created a FastAPI service to help Product Owners in Jira control deployments from GitLab.

[Python Engineer, Worldwide Tech Services, 2015 to 2023, Home](#)

Grew an international team to replace programs on Windows in VB to websites on Linux in Python.

Brought Linux, Bash, Python, ... into a large Windows, CMD.EXE, Basic, ... company and taught them how, too.

Deployed from Slack to Jira to Unix, Bash, Python, Git, TEST, REST, Yaml, Ansible, Docker, Kubernetes, to servers in the clouds.

Mentored, monitored and motivated developers to Test Quality into lovely code.

[Licensing Engineer, S3 Group, 2014, Home](#)

Helped bring major contract to enforce Open Source licensing on a TV conglomerates' developers in a “private GitHub”.

Learned enough Law to introduce new rules to hundreds of developers across many international companies.

[Founding Engineer, Altobridge, 2003 to 2013, Tralee / Home](#)

Helped interWave move their OMC software development from Silicon Valley to Ireland.

Led team, with interns from nearby college writing production SCM code to help 150 international Managers, Engineers, Customers.

Led drive to ISO-9000 and DO-178B certifications, allowing our software into villages, ships, planes.

Wrote parser in Python to translate “RIAS” from Java to C++, saving 60% of RAM usage aboard planes, preventing costly refit.

Drove the addition of AI to reduce data usage at Remote Gateways in v2.0

[Earlier, Wexford / Tralee](#)

Created and delivered courses from 1-week commercial training to 2-year C&G Software Engineering certification.

Taught *everyone* (classrooms, offices) to better use computers; helped blind friends become Software Engineers.

Translated Flextime's software from Visual Basic to COBOL for use at the Central Statistics Office, just in time for Y2K.

Wrote the chapter on “How To Test” in “The Borland C++ Book for Windows”

Education

BSc in Computer Science, Institute of Technology, Tralee, 2001, First Class Honours.

- Dissertation: Using Recurrent Neural Nets to learn parsed Syntax Trees (of C programs)

425 Certificate in Application Development, City & Guilds, 1988, A+

Medicine, University College Dublin, 1984. Honours

Leaving Cert, 1979: A, A, A, A, B, B.

Open Source

Since Python made Open Source readable I have been a believer in, and contributor to, the community.

I was lucky enough to write Python to enhance a tool in work, which was adopted upstream, and used to help the “python-devs” mailing list, where they develop Python 🧐

My own projects are at <https://github.com/jalanb> e.g.

1. <https://github.com/jalanb/co.py.cat> which “translated” Douglas Hofstadter’s Copycat algorithm from sources in Lisp, Java and English. It was accepted by the Fargonauts into their collection, <https://github.com/fargonauts/FARGonautica> .
2. Extended how IPython handled doctests is my best example of improving a well-known tool to scratch my own itch. <https://github.com/tkf/ipython-doctestmagic/pull/1>
3. `e()` remains “the most productive function I have ever written”, and a Redditor called it “witty”. It is at https://github.com/jalanb/whyp/blob/___main___/whyp.sh#L25

Communities

Contributions to many Open Source projects, from typo fixing through issues to full features. My contributions include IPython, Ansible, ack-grep, pudb, travis, and more. You can find helpful PRs at <https://bit.ly/jalanb-code> and questions at <https://bit.ly/jalanb-issues> .

Started the Vim Stack Exchange community <https://vi.stackexchange.com>

Regular volunteer at CoderDojos

Recommendations

LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/jalanb/details/recommendations>

ChatGPT: <https://chatgpt.com/share/6719528f-d9a8-800f-acec-1bb3c898ac55>